

The good news is Microsoft, Wipro and e-Serve are hiring; the tough part is you need to be prepared. How do you look for that dream job? What skillsets are in demand? And how do you write the perfect résumé?

Anand Bose, a commerce graduate from National College, Mumbai, puts a twist to the "India Shining" phrase. He has two years of work experience in sales, and he's now looking for recruitment advertisements by IT companies. "IT shining!" is the reason.

The IT sector was primarily the domain of engineers and computer science professionals. What brings Commerce and Humanities graduates into IT?

The dotcom bust of 2000 resulted in pink slips, and a sluggish US economy put an embargo on IT professionals. But post 2002, favourable government policies, combined with a global belief in offshore development, resulted in Indian IT companies expanding their workforce, and increased opportunities—both in terms of working on the technical side and customer support. Today, most ads in newspapers are for the IT, and ITES (IT

Enabled Services) sector, which comprises Business Process Outsourcing (BPOs) and call centres.

Considering that there are approximately 2,90,000 fresh engineering graduates, and more than two million English-speaking graduates added to the workforce every year—according to Nasscom (National Association of Software and Service Companies)—what kind of prospects does IT offer?

IT: Specialist vs Generalist

According to the Nasscom Strategic Review this year, IT's contribution to the nation's Gross Domestic Product increased from 1.4 per cent in 1998-99 to 3 per cent in 2002-03. And recruitment is definitely on the rise. According to A N Pruthwi, Staffing Manager—India for Microsoft, "We are witnessing a period peak of 1998-2000—the dotcom phase; by 2005 we would hit that stage and go beyond."

IT's happening!



What are companies looking for?

All Web-based applications are finding takers. Companies are lapping up people with Java/J2EE and .Net skills. As Vijay Mukhi, Founder, Vijay Mukhi's Computer Institute, says, "With the introduction of Microsoft's Visual Studio 2005, the demand for .Net expertise is on the rise, as most companies are Microsoft-based." Asad Kadri, Manager-Resourcing, of Mumbai-based Patni